

reduce the time and cost linked to application development. In 4.5 Flex has extended its extensive existing web and desktop component library by 21 new touch enabled, optimised, and density-aware mobile components, accelerating mobile application development. In addition to the new mobile components, Flex 4.5 adds other important capabilities and improvements for building mobile applications including kinetics and elastic bounce/pull effects for scrolling components.

Flash Builder 4.5 also adds important new mobile development workflows to help you code, debug, and optimise mobile applications. It features a new mobile project type, new design-view per-device preview, new support for multi-density authoring, per-platform application permissions editing, and a powerful new debugging workflow that allows you to debug on a physical device or on the desktop using a device emulator. You can deploy, package, and sign the required resources as a platform-specific installer file for upload to a mobile application distribution site or store.

For the rest of this book, we will be building applications for the desktop and mobile devices making use of the Flex 4.5 platform and the tools available in Flash Builder 4.5. This is a recent release from Adobe, so be sure to download the latest update before trying out the exercises in this book.

What is AIR?

The Adobe Integrated Runtime, or Air, is a cross platform runtime. Basically what it means is that it's a wrapper for rich internet applications to be installed on several Operating systems. It is freely available and downloadable from the Adobe web site just like the Flash Player. You will get rich and engaging visuals from the applications you create for Adobe Air as it includes a lot of built-in graphic capabilities. Also the applications will run on Windows, Linux and Mac machines with little or no code modification on your part. Finally your users will also enjoy a quick and simple installation through Adobe Air runtime.

You can build Air applications using HTML and JavaScript which are then rendered inside an Air application using the Open Source Webkit HTML and JavaScript engine. So, you can use a HTML editor like Dreamweaver or even plain Notepad to create Air applications. You can also build Air applications using the Adobe Flash Builder 4.5, which is exactly what we will be doing in this book. While Flex was traditionally